Signé par Em

No. 20

COLLECTION

SELLERS

Sell

Document
pitfalls

2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

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COLLECTION SELLERS · GUIDE NO. 20

Selling your condo

Documents, fees and co-ownership-specific pitfalls

Selling a condo is not like selling a house: the buyer also buys a share of a co-ownership, with its finances, its rules and its history. A well-prepared file reassures the buyer and speeds up the sale.

This guide covers the documents to gather, how to present the charges and the contingency fund, and the pitfalls specific to selling in co-ownership.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page.

Selling a condo is not selling a house: co-ownership adds documents, collective figures and typical buyers. This guide shows you how to prepare the file, present the finances of the building, market it and avoid the pitfalls specific to condos.

The idea: transform co-ownership life into an argument for trust.

CHAPTER

Prepare the co-ownership file

> *Gather in advance what the buyer will require.*

- Declaration of co-ownership and regulations for the building.
- Financial statements, budget and amount of expenses up to date.
- Balance of the provident fund, study of the fund, maintenance log.
- Minutes of the last meetings.
- Insurance certificate and statement of special contributions voted.

An informed and reassured buyer negotiates less and withdraws less. Preparing this file in advance is a sales accelerator.

A condo buyer (and his notary, his lender) will require the co-ownership file: declaration, regulations, financial statements, contingency fund, minutes. Bringing it together in advance speeds up the sale and projects an image of sound management.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Gather the co-ownership file BEFORE even putting it up for sale. When the buyer requests the documents and everything is ready, you inspire confidence and maintain momentum.*

CHAPTER

Present expenses and contingency funds

> *Transform a sensitive point into an argument for confidence.*

The expenses and health of the contingency fund are scrutinized by informed buyers. A solid fund and realistic charges are selling points; a weak fund will be a bargaining point.

- Highlight a well-capitalized contingency fund and a well-managed building.
- Be transparent about any special contributions voted for or to come.
- Explain what the charges cover (services, maintenance, reserve).

The expenses and health of the provident fund are closely scrutinized: present them clearly rather than endure them. A well-stocked fund and a transparent management history become arguments of confidence - not weak points.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *A solid retirement fund is a selling point, not just an obligation. Highlight it: it reassures the buyer that there will be no unpleasant surprises in the future.*

CHAPTER

Marketing a condo

> *Enhance the assets specific to co-ownership.*

- Highlight the location, the building's amenities (elevator, gym, terrace) and the "maintenance-free" lifestyle.
- Home staging adapted to small spaces: declutter, maximize light and the impression of space.
- Target the right buyer (first time buyer, professional, downsizing retiree) depending on the condo.

A condo is sold on a lifestyle as much as on square meters: tell the story of this lifestyle.

For a condo, value what is unique to it: location, building amenities, low maintenance, security, parking. Target the lifestyle that your unit allows - it is often this, more than the surface area, that triggers the crush.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Sell the lifestyle: proximity, security, amenities, freedom without maintenance. For many condo buyers, this is the real product.*

CHAPTER

Specific pitfalls to avoid

> *Anticipate what derails a condo sale.*

- Incomplete or untraceable documents: delay and worry the buyer.
- Undisclosed special contribution: source of withdrawal or dispute.
- Declaration restrictions (rental, animals) which put off some buyers: to be clarified early.
- Known building problems (infiltrations, disputes): it is better to approach them frankly.

Transparency on co-ownership is your best ally: it avoids surprises that derail a transaction at the last minute.

The classic traps: incomplete or unobtainable documents (delays and worrying), low contingency fund, undisclosed co-ownership disputes, restrictive rules ignored. Anticipate them: they are the ones who derail a condo sale at the last minute.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Never let the buyer discover a special assessment or real estate dispute on his own. What you openly disclose is negotiable; what we discover makes us flee or pursue.*

CHAPTER

Who is your condo for?

> *Adapt the sale to the typical buyer.*

A condo is not sold to “everyone”. Identify your **typical buyer** helps to present it better:

- **First buyer** : sensitive to price, charges and proximity to services.
- **Downsizer** (retired): seeks comfort, tranquility and low maintenance.
- **Investor** : looks at the yield, the permitted rental and the charges.

Highlight the arguments that speak to your most likely buyer: location, lifestyle, or profitability.

Adapt your marketing to the most likely buyer: first buyer sensitive to price and charges, retiree looking for peace of mind, or investor attentive to yield and permitted rental. The same condo, two different speeches depending on the target.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Adapt your marketing to the most likely buyer of YOUR condo. A 3½ near the metro is sold to a first-time buyer; a large, quiet condo appeals to a retiree. The same good, two speeches.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Gather the complete co-ownership file.
2. Check the status of the provident fund and contributions.

Within 30 days

1. Prepare a reassuring presentation of expenses and funds.
2. Adapting home staging to condo spaces.

Then

1. Market by targeting the right buyer, with Emilie.

Before displaying

1. Gather the complete co-ownership file (declaration, finances, minutes).
2. Identify my typical buyer and adapt my argument.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Co-ownership file: set of documents to be provided to the buyer.
- Contingency fund: collective savings for major projects, an argument for confidence.
- Special contribution: exceptional sum to be disclosed if voted or to come.
- Co-ownership charges: fees covering services, maintenance and reservation.
- Condo home staging: enhancement adapted to small spaces.

- Co-ownership file: set of documents required by the buyer.
- Provident fund: collective reserve; his health reassures or worries.
- Co-ownership charges: monthly management and maintenance fees.
- Minutes: history of decisions and problems of the building.
- Typical buyer: most likely profile, which guides marketing.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. By selling a condo, the buyer also buys:

A) Nothing more

B) A share of the co-ownership and its history

C) The entire building

D) The neighboring land

2. The co-ownership file should be ready:

A) After the sale

B) Even before going on sale

C) Never

D) To the notary only

3. A solid contingency fund is:

A) A disadvantage

B) A reassuring selling point

C) Unimportant

D) A secret

4. A special contribution voted on must be:

A) Hidden

B) Disclosed with transparency

C) Ignored

D) Paid by the buyer without saying so

5. A condo is sold mainly on:

A) The only square meters

B) A way of life (location, amenities, maintenance free)

C) The welcome tax

D) The basement

6. A common pitfall is:

A) A complete file

B) Incomplete or untraceable documents

C) Too much transparency

D) A good fund

7. Restrictions (rental, animals) must be:

A) Hidden

B) Clarified early

C) Invented

D) Ignored

8. The best ally when selling a condo is:

A) Opacity

B) Transparency on co-ownership

C) Rush

D) Silence

Answers

1. B - He adheres to the community (intro and chap. 1).

2. B - This reassures and maintains momentum (chap. 1).

3. B - He reassures about the absence of surprises (chap. 2).

4. B - Transparency avoids retraction and litigation (chapters 2 and 4).

5. B - We talk about the lifestyle (chap. 3).

6. B - This delays and worries the buyer (chap. 4).

7. B - They can put off some buyers (chap. 4).

8. B - She avoids last minute surprises (chap. 4).

Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Move forward without regret.

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